#FABCONSQLCON2026

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Microsoft Fabric COMMUNITY CONFERENCE | Microsoft SQL COMMUNITY CONFERENCE

ATLANTA MARCH 16 - 20, 2026

Microsoft Fabric Capacities

Essentials for Smarter Operations

Sanjay Raut, Pat Mahoney, Matt Stenzel

Principal PM's - Azure Data CAT

Meet the Speakers and Proctors

- Speakers
  - Matt Stenzel
  - Sanjay Raut
  - Pat Mahoney

- Proctors
  - Tim Bindas
  - Pratik Patel

Full-Day Workshop Agenda Timeline

9:00 AM

Session 1 - Capacity Concepts (75 min)

CU model, bursting, throttling, hands-on lab [1]

10:30 AM

Session 2 - Recovery & Advanced Config (90 min)

Throttling recovery, advanced settings, licensing [1]

1:30 PM

Session 3 - Monitoring & Events (120 min)

Metrics App, Real-Time Hub, chargeback demos [1]

3:30 PM

Session 4 - Planning & Optimization (30 min)

Best practices, scale decisions, workload isolation [1]

4:00 PM

Session 5 - Q&A with Leadership (30 min)

Open forum with Capacity Engineering Leadership [1]

- Structured learning progression: From foundational concepts to advanced topics
- Interactive engagement with hands-on labs, live demonstrations
- WIFI: Info on back of badge
- Bonus - dedicated Q&A sessions towards end of the day to ask further clarifications around real capacity scenarios
- Lunch Break:
  - 12:00 Noon to 1:30 PM

Session 2 – Capacity Roles and Permissions

Roles, Permission & Licensing

Fabric Permissions: Layered Roles

Tenant

Control if Fabric is enabled and what features are allowed

Capacity

Manage and place workspaces on capacities

Workspace

Create, modify and use items

Item-level Permissions

Fine-grained access to individual items

Capacity Roles

Capacity Administrator

What You Can Do	What You Cannot Do
Change capacity settings	No access to workspace content
Add and remove capacity admins	Cannot edit data or reports
Assign workspaces to the capacity	
Configure workload settings	

Capacity Contributor

What You Can Do	What You Cannot Do
Assign / remove workspaces	Change capacity settings
	Add and remove admins and contributors
	Delete capacity

Workspace Roles

Role	Key Capabilities
Admin	Full control, users, permissions, settings, content
Member	Create, edit, share content
Contributor	Create/edit content, limited sharing
Viewer	Read-only access

Item Permissions

Permission	Description
Read	View only
Write	Create and modify
Execute	Run processes
Reshare	Share with others
Explore	Analyze and interact

Fabric Capacity Licensing

Power BI
Individual User Licenses

Free:
Allows users to access the Fabric/Power BI service where they can initiate trials, use Fabric items hosted on Fabric capacity (trial or paid), use Power BI items created by themselves in their My Workspace, view Power BI items hosted on Power BI Premium capacity or F64+ Fabric capacity

Pro:
Enable users create, read, and interact with Power BI item. Users with this license type can share content and collaborate with other Pro users. Only Pro users can publish, share, or consume other Pro users' item unless it resides in a Power BI Premium capacity. If a Power BI Premium capacity hosts the item, Pro users can also share and collaborate with free and PPU users.

Premium Per-User (PPU):
A PPU license provides all Power BI Pro capabilities plus most Premium capacity features. PPU licenses allow organizations to access Power BI Premium features by licensing every user with a PPU license instead of purchasing a Power BI Premium.

Power BI Shared/Capacity License

Embedded
A dedicated Azure capacity designed for embedding Power BI analytics into custom applications for external users, with predictable performance.

Premium Capacity
A dedicated capacity that provides enhanced performance, larger dataset sizes, and advanced features for enterprise workloads shared across users and workspaces.

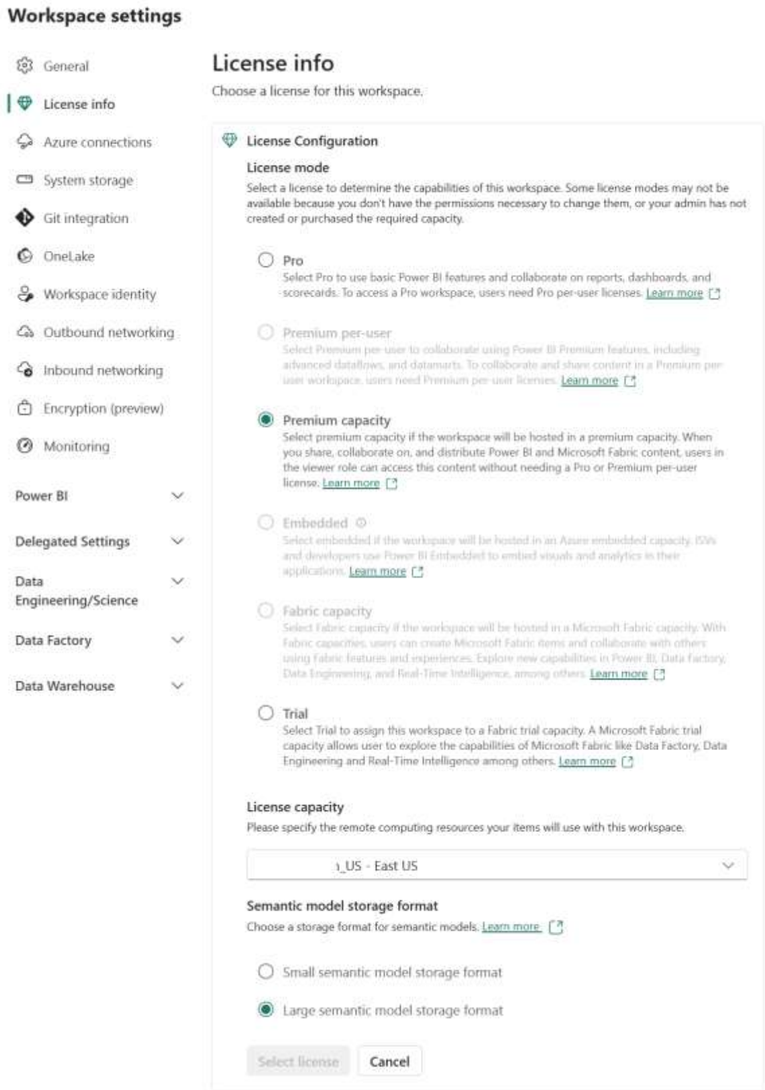
Fabric Capacity
A dedicated capacity that provides enhanced performance, larger dataset sizes, and advanced features for enterprise workloads shared across users and workspaces. Adds additional flexibility and security features over Premium Capacity

Trial
A time-limited capacity that provides temporary access to Microsoft Fabric features for evaluation and learning, with usage and scale constraints.

Workspace Settings License Mode

The workspace settings License info determines the type of workspace that will be created

- Pro
- Premium Per User
- Embedded
- Premium Capacity
- Fabric Capacity
- Trial



Getting Started With Fabric Capacities

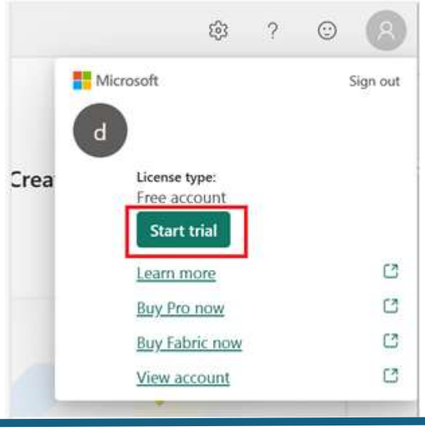
Enable Fabric on your existing P SKU OR

Users can create Fabric items
Enabled for the entire organization

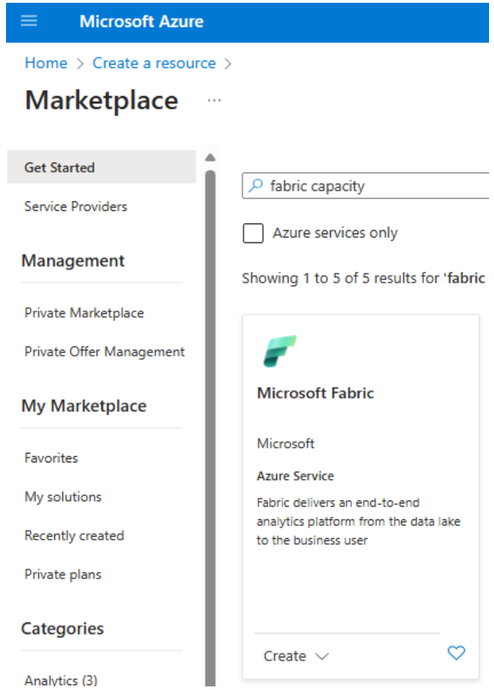
Users can use production-ready features to create Fabric items. Turning off this setting doesn't impact users' ability to create Power BI items. This setting can be managed at both the tenant and the capacity levels. Learn More

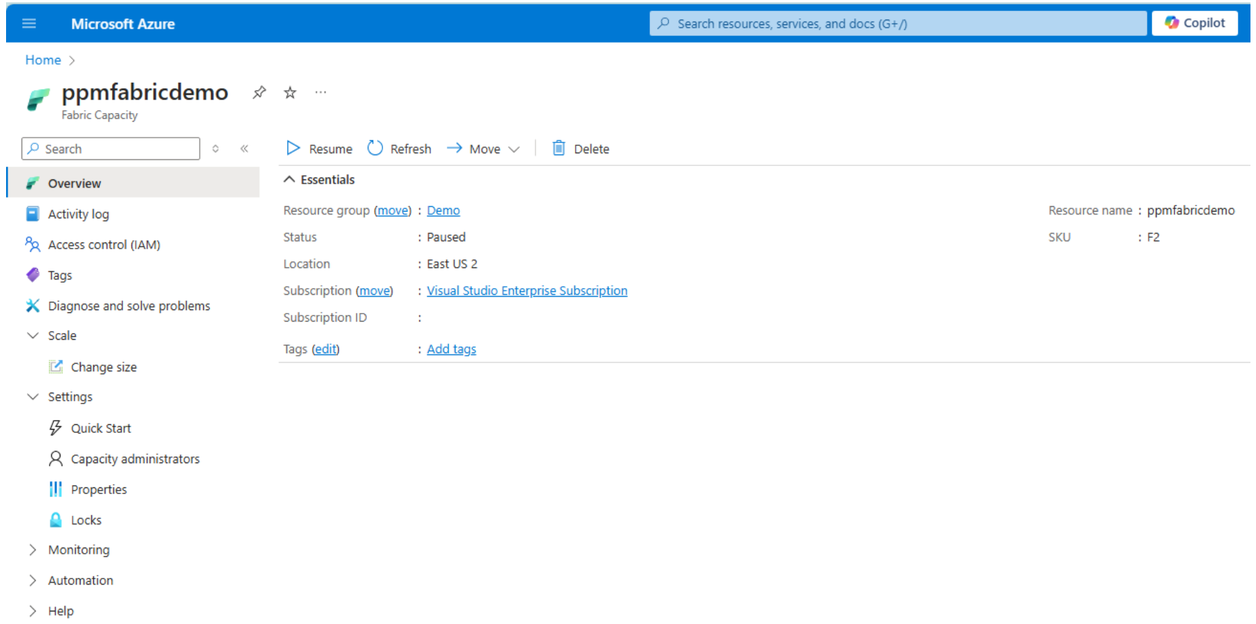
Enabled

Quickly create a trial capacity OR



Easily create a new F SKU





Pause/Resume/Resize in seconds in the UI

P SKU vs F SKU

Feature	F SKU	P SKUs
Power BI Autoscale	❌	✅
Copilot	All F SKUs	✅
Managed Private Endpoints	All F SKUs or trial capacity	❌
Trusted workspace access	All F SKUs	❌
ARM APIs and Terraform	✅	❌
Pause and Resume your capacity	✅	❌
On-demand resizing	✅	❌
Bring your own key for Power BI	✅	✅
Private links	✅	✅

Fabric SKU Estimator

Enabling customers to better estimate their SKU before purchase

Online calculator

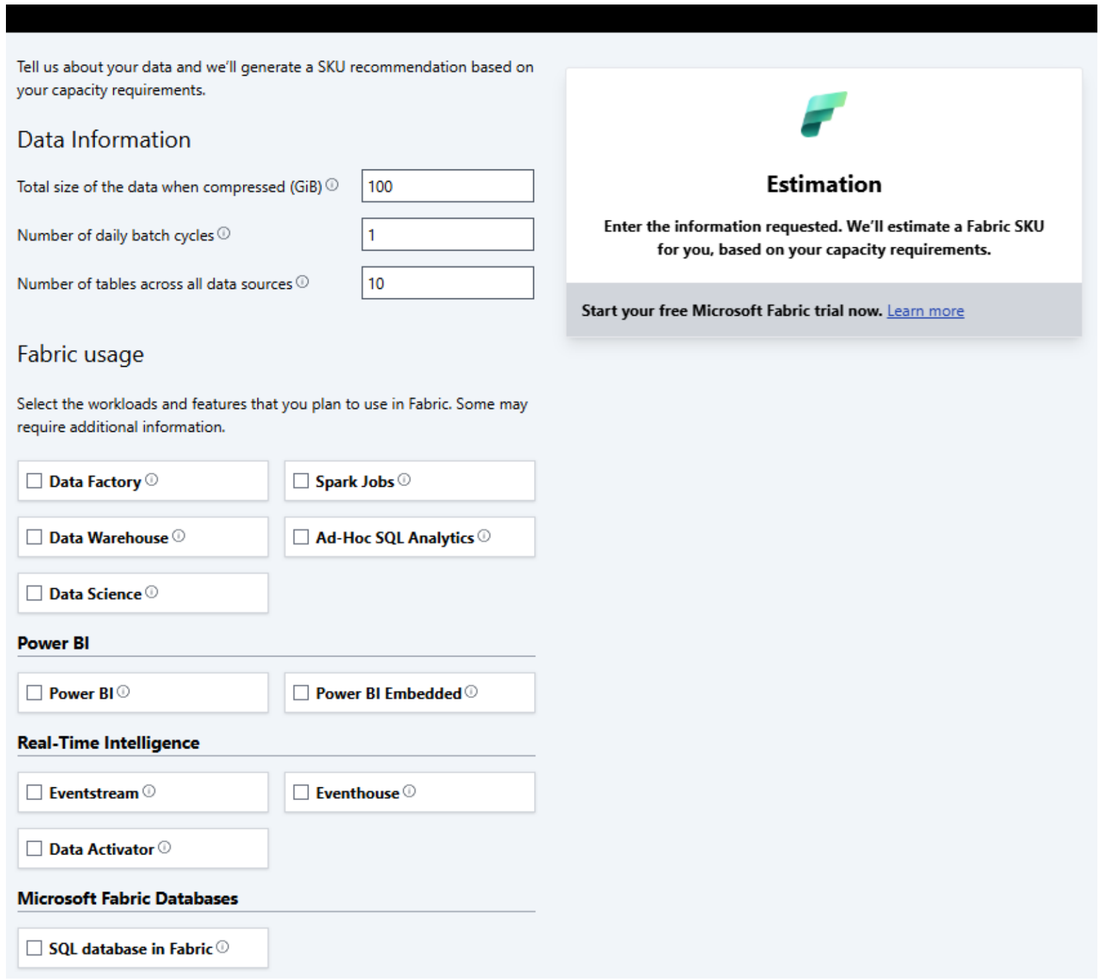
- Provides capacity estimations customized to your unique requirements
- Results vary depending on your input

Impact

- Recommended SKU when starting on Fabric
- Test solutions to ensure they're correctly sized.

Learn more?

- Fabric Tech Talks - Estimating Capacity in Microsoft Fabric
- Blog – Master SKU Estimations



https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-fabric/capacity-estimator

Group Workspace

Free users can consume only when content is hosted on Fabric capacity or Power BI Premium (F64+).

Workspace Types	Create	Manage	Consume	Share	Execute
Power BI Pro	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Power BI PPU	PPU	PPU	PPU	PPU	PPU
Power BI Embedded	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Trial					
Power BI Items	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Fabric Items	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free
Fabric					
PBI Items (F < 64)	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
PBI Items (F >= 64)	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Fabric Items	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free
PBI Premium					
PBI Items	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Fabric Items	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free

My Workspace

Free users can consume only when content is hosted on Fabric capacity or Power BI Premium (F64+).

Workspace Types	Create	Manage	Consume	Share	Execute
Power BI Pro	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU/Free
Power BI PPU	PPU	PPU	PPU	PPU	PPU
Power BI Embedded	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Trial					
Power BI Items	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Fabric Items	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free
Fabric					
PBI Items (F < 64)	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
PBI Items (F >= 64)	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Fabric Items	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free
PBI Premium					
PBI Items	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU	Pro/PPU
Fabric Items	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free	Pro/PPU/Free

Fabric Copilot Capacity

Fabric Copilot Capacity

Enable everyone in your org to use Copilot and manage its cost (blog || docs)

Enable everyone to use Copilot

- All users can use Copilot experiences
- Consumption of Copilot goes to only the selected capacity

Select who can use a Copilot capacity

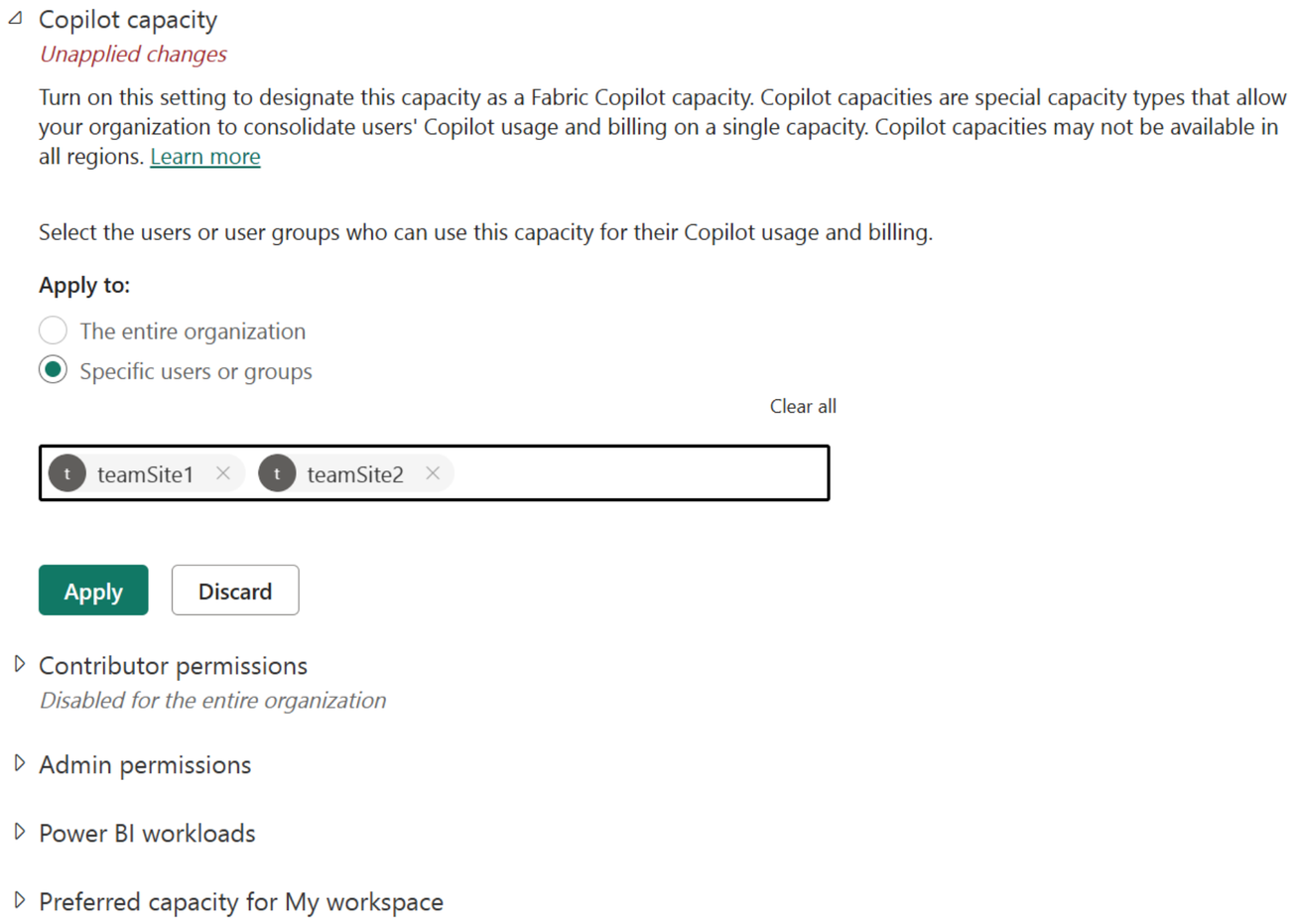
- Select the Users or groups who use a specific Copilot capacity
- A user can have only one Copilot capacity
  - Newest one matters..

No longer just P & F SKUs

- Pro, Premium Per User, and Trial

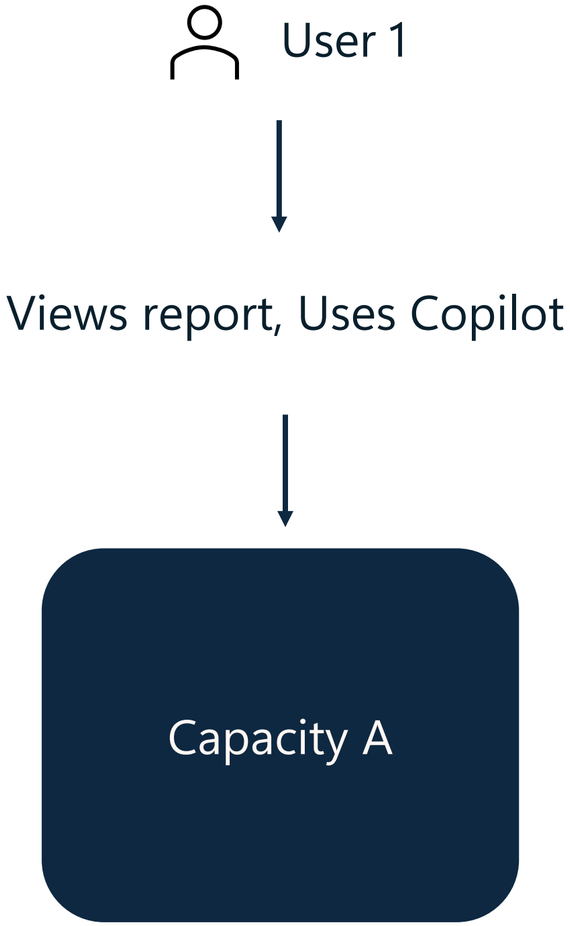
Tenant Setting

- Restrict who can configure
- "Capacities can be delegated .."



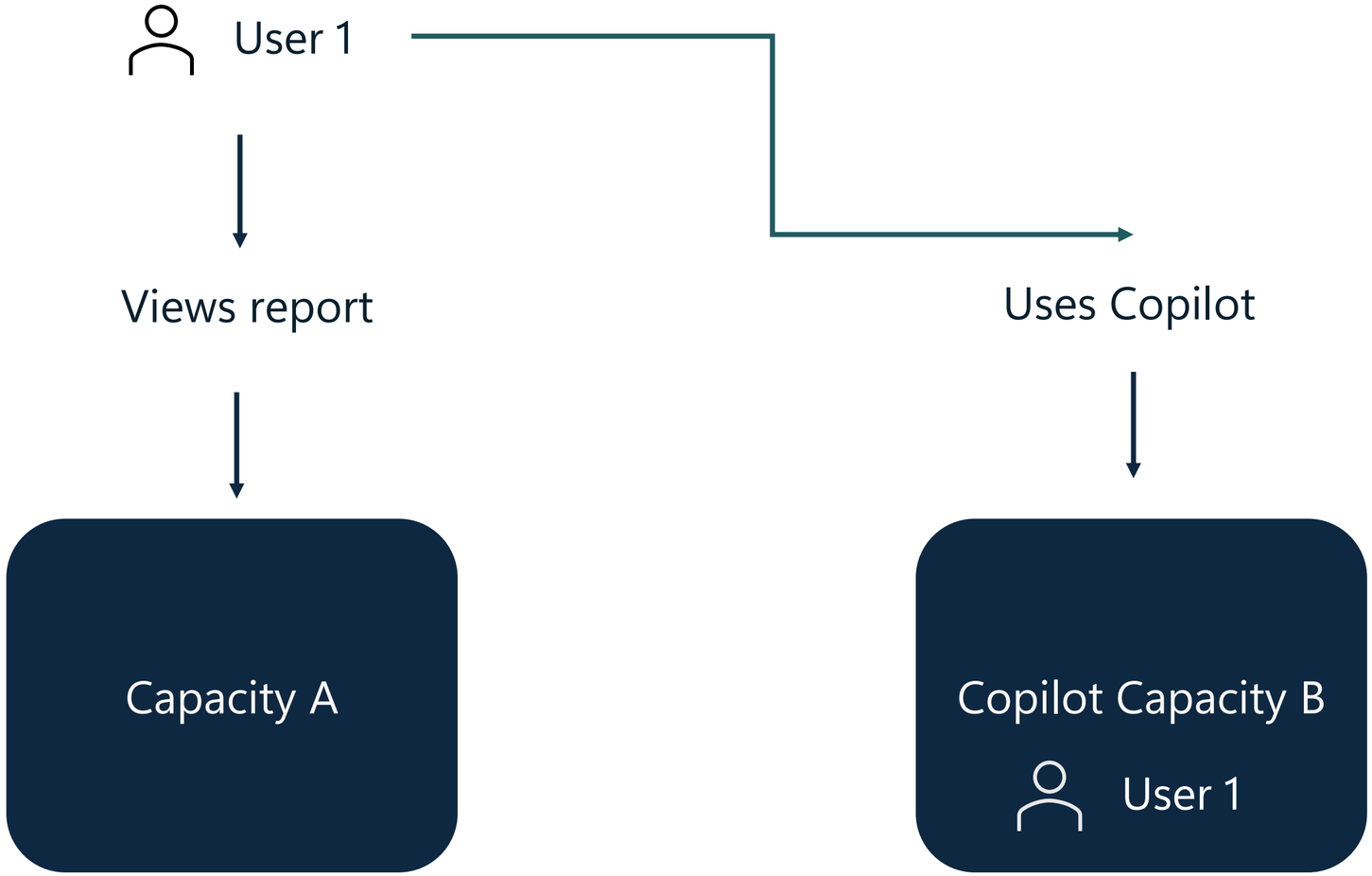
Fabric Copilot capacity

Normally, copilot usage applies to the capacity the content is in.



Fabric Copilot capacity

After a user is added to a copilot capacity, the user's copilot usage is consumed from their copilot capacity



Protecting your capacity from Copilot usage

Copilot in Fabric operations are background, so no immediate spikes

But when they do .. it has a 24h impact

Be mindful of who has access to Copilot skills and educate!

Copilot requests trigger other operations too!

Track usage for Power BI Desktop, ensuring usage doesn't interfere with key workloads

ℹ️ Daily check for "Power BI Session Desktop" item name in Metrics App

Any workspace with permissions (Contributor), on Capacity that allows Copilot usage

If user is assigned a Copilot Capacity, it automatically goes here

Protecting your capacity from Copilot usage

- Options to ensure the health of your capacity
  - Fabric Copilot Capacity enabled for user base (by region, department, ..)
    - If possible, set up new Security Groups (avoid cross pollination)
  - When Capacity throttles/rejects, Copilot no longer works
    - But everything else does .. 😾

Fabric Capacity Quota

Azure Quota Management Service Integration

Better resource allocation to meet Microsoft's customer capacity needs (blog || docs)

New Fabric Quota limits

- Limits the number of Capacity Units (CUs) you can provision across multiple capacities in a subscription, based on subscription type and region

Customers can request a quota adjustment

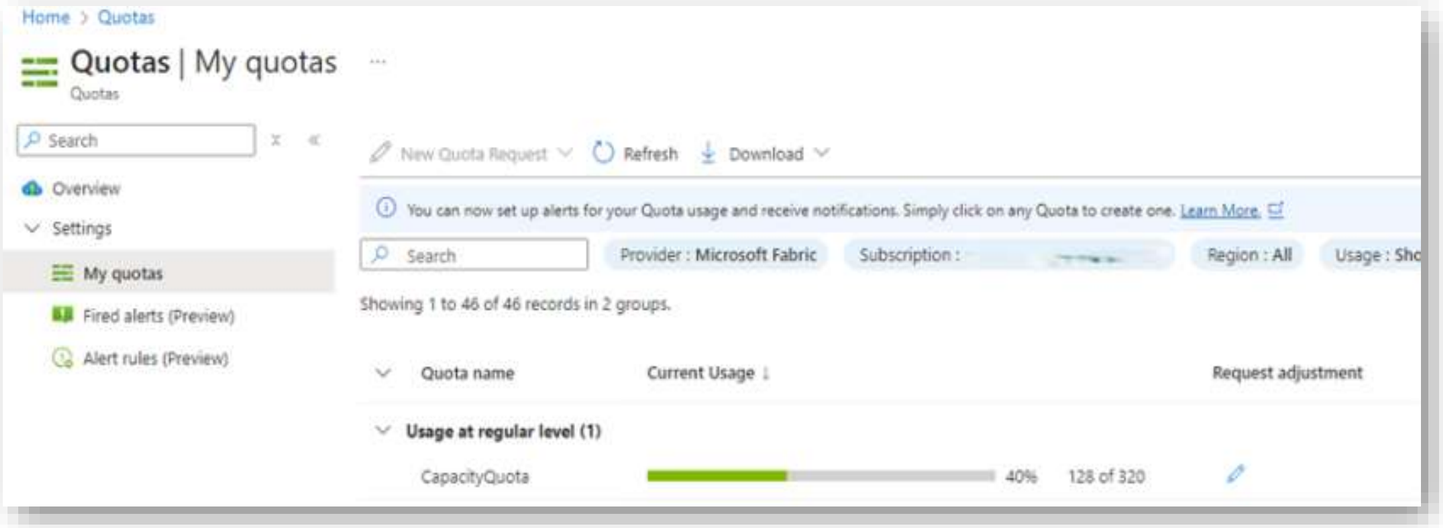
- Auto approved up to specific limits
- Customers can request additional quota through Microsoft customer support

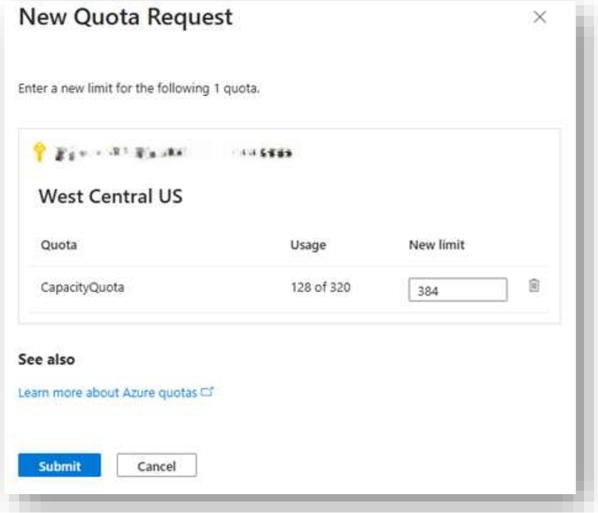
Update automation scripts

- Customers who provision capacity dynamically should check quota first

Impact

- Better resource allocation
- Security and compliance – reduce risk of unauthorized excessive usage





Fabric Capacity Reservations

Fabric Capacity Reservations

Commit to spending for 1-year periods, to get a 41% discount

Existing Azure Concept

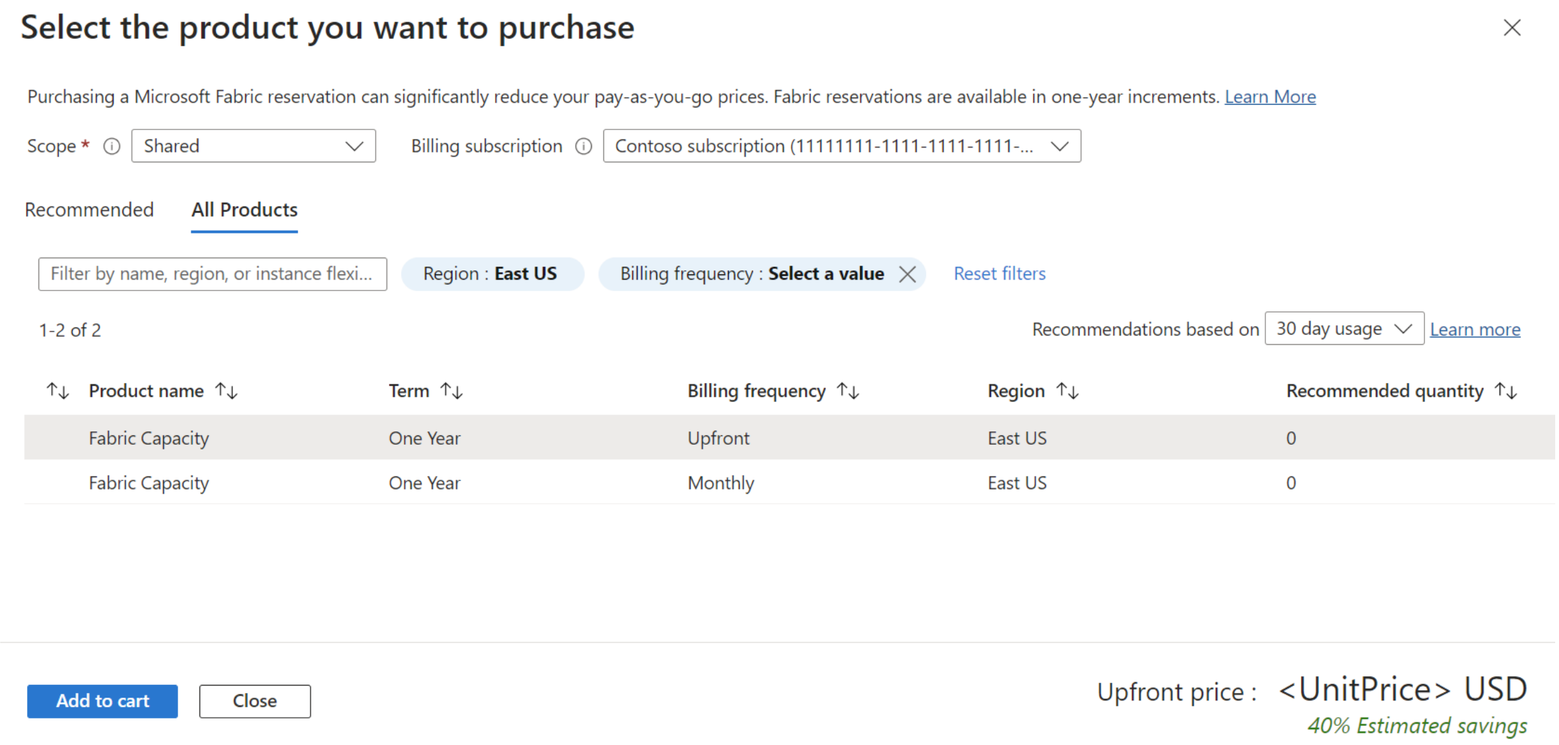
- Cancel, Refund, Exchange by policies

Reservations can be configured by

- Scope:
  - Billing Account
  - Subscription(s)
  - Resource Group(s)
  - Region
- Management Group

Reservation that is enforced

- Even when no capacity matches the scope, billing happens
- Not automatically renewed, unless configured
- Upon expiry, capacities impacted automatically switch to PayGo



Fabric Capacity Reservations

Example 1 – Single Reservation matching a single capacity

Billing Account / Subscription / Resource Group / Region

Reservation of 64CU

F64 Capacity (Active)

Active capacity is covered by Reservation, discount applies

Fabric Capacity Reservations

Example 2 – Single Reservation exceeds Active Capacities

Billing Account / Subscription / Resource Group / Region

Reservation of 64CU ❗ ❗

F32 Capacity (Active)

F32 Capacity (Paused)❗ ❗

Reservation only applies to active capacity, 32CU are "wasted"

Fabric Capacity Reservations

Example 3 – Single SKU exceeding the reservation amount

Billing Account / Subscription / Resource Group / Region

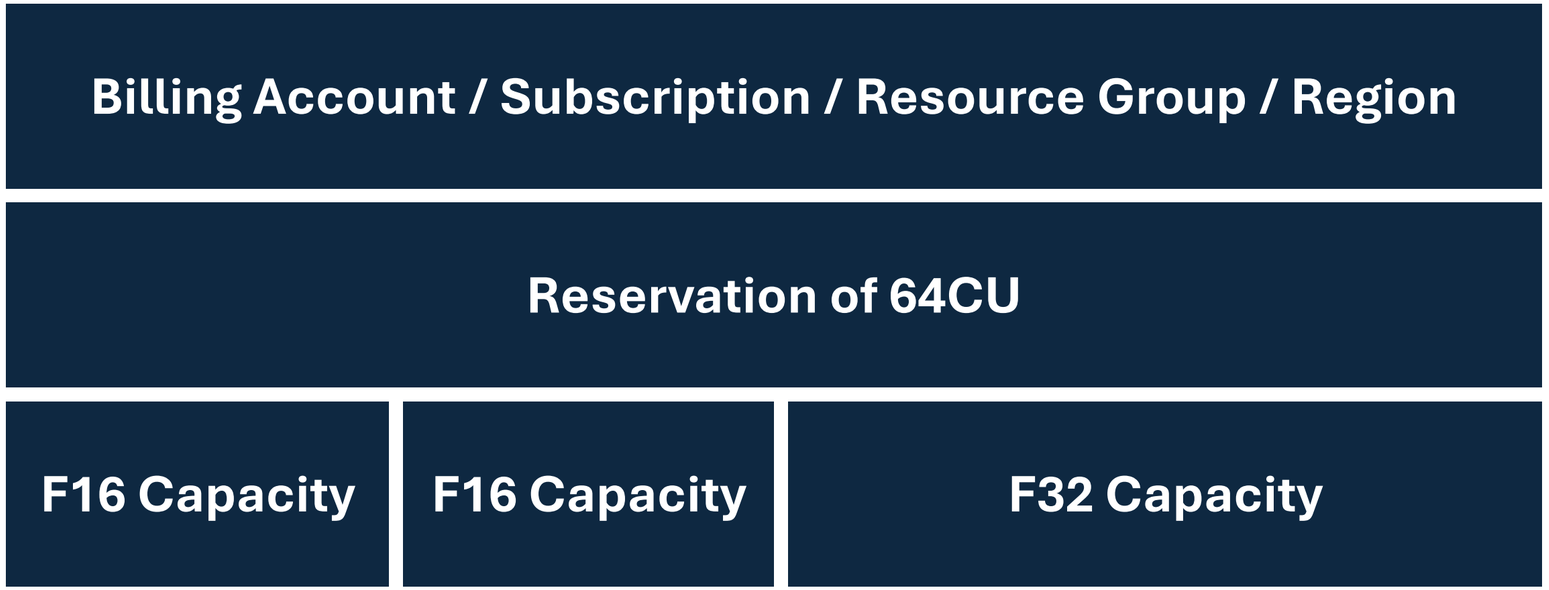
Reservation of 64CU

F128 Capacity (Active)

Mixed billing for F128 Capacity, 64CU reserved, 64CU PaYGo

Fabric Capacity Reservations

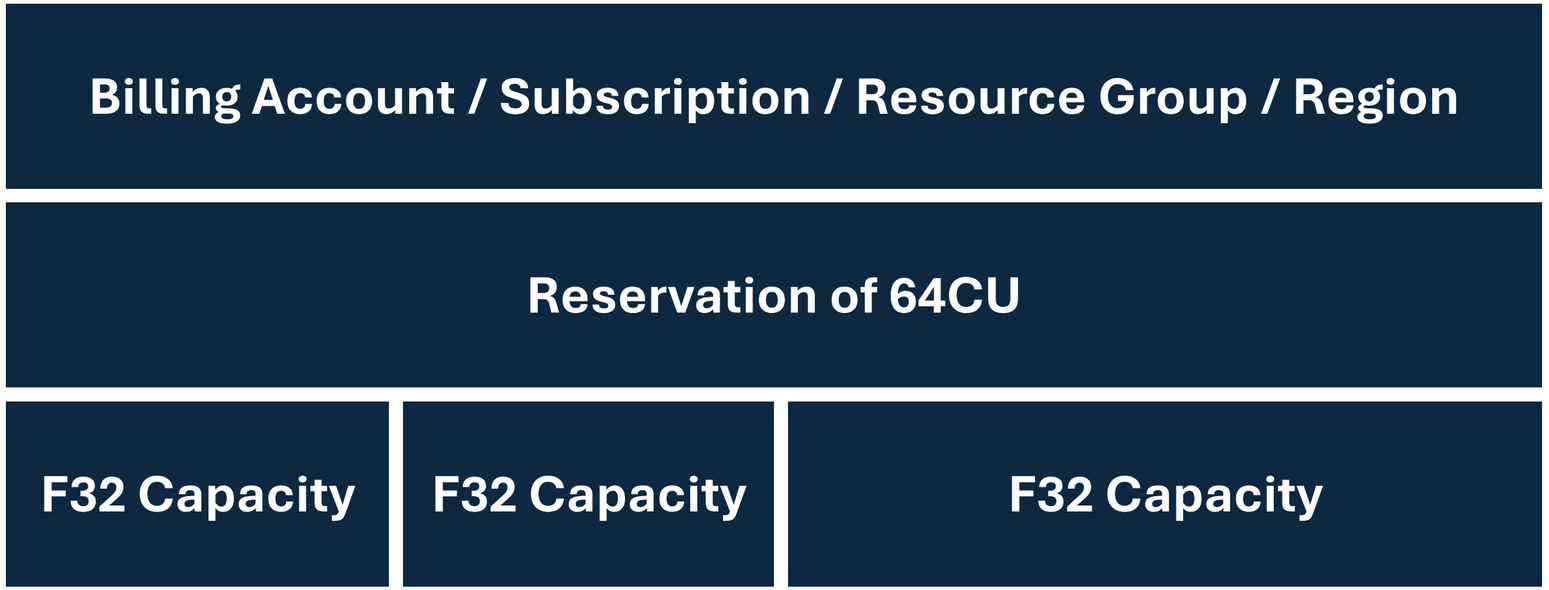
Example 4 – Single Reservation matches active capacities



All active capacities are covered by Reservation, discount applies

Fabric Capacity Reservations

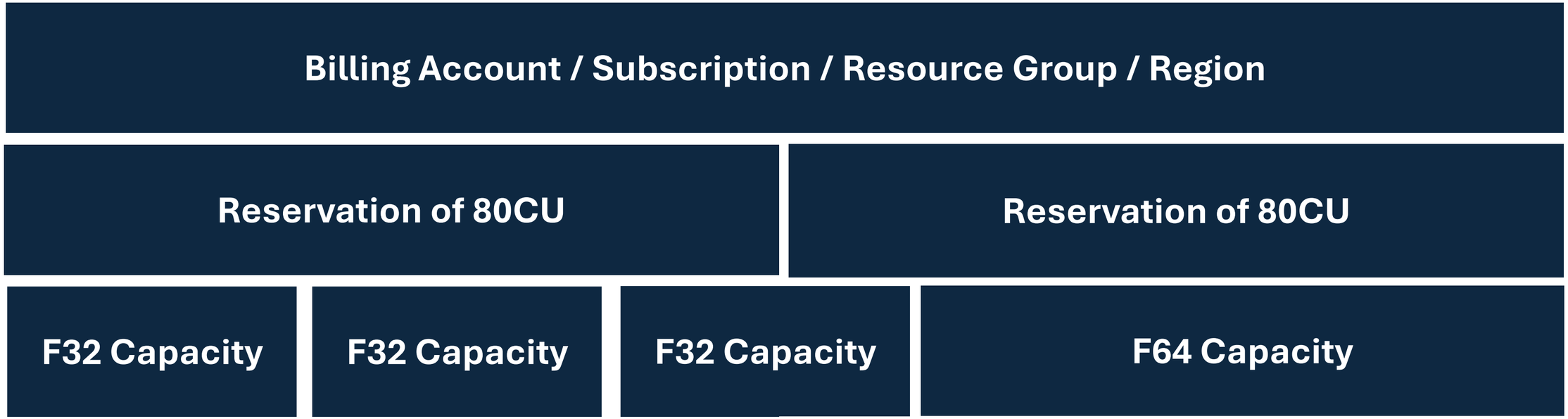
Example 5 – Multiple SKUs exceeding reservation amount



Billing can apply to all of the F32 capacities, is only shown in Billing

Fabric Capacity Reservations

Example 6 – Multiple SKUs matching reservation amount through multiple reservations



Only when second Reservation is added, all Capacities are covered

Sound off.
The mic is all yours.
Influence the product roadmap.

Join the Fabric User Panel

Share your feedback directly with our Fabric product group and researchers.

https://aka.ms/JoinFabricUserPanel

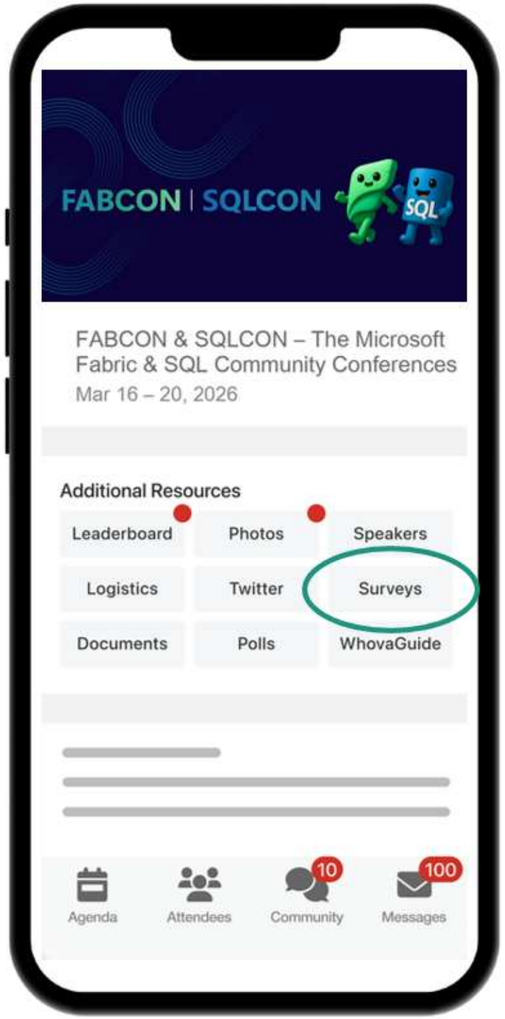
Join the SQL User Panel

Influence our SQL roadmap and ensure it meets your real-life needs

https://aka.ms/JoinSQLUserPanel

How was the session?

Complete Session Surveys in Whova for your chance to WIN PRIZES!



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